

Fuji FinePix F402

All looks, no juice

The F402 is yet another designer camera with a sleek square look. The best part about it is that it has no standard on or off button. Instead, the camera has a big flap on its front that slides open, and powers the camera. The blue LED on this flap is the indicator of its power mode. The camera is just 2.2 cms thick and weighs 125 gms, making it very pocketable. It is equipped with a 2.1 megapixel CCD, which churns out 2304 x 1728 resolution images. The camera supports ISO setting from 200 to 1600—a range normally found in more expensive cameras. It also supports shutter speeds from 1/2 to 1/2000 of a second, making sure that you capture fast moving objects and images in poor light conditions. The 6 cms to 65 cms macro focus range lets you get a good close-up on subjects such as petals and leaves to give you an excellent image. The camera stores the images in a 16 MB xD-Picture card that's bundled along. A custom Li-ion battery and an AC adapter also come along with the camera.

The F402 delivered very average-looking test images, as it could not focus even in the auto mode. Due to this, the keyboard text was not readable and the flower petals looked blurry. The camera reproduced colour well, but it was not on par with others. It was the same with specular effects; it created a very blunt reproduction of the liquid-filled glass and the metal table clock. The image was bright in the middle and dark in the corner, indicating that the camera metering mode in auto setting was not proper. It returned dark images when tested in a sufficiently-lit room. The 3.6X digital zoom does a decent job of getting a distant object nearer.

The F402 is priced at Rs 30,000, which makes it very costly, especially because it lacks optical zoom, and also has a limited manual override. This camera, like the Exilim EX-M1, is foppish eye-candy that will only appeal to a select few.



Fuji FinePix F402

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Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

+ Slim form factor
– Very expensive
Price: Rs 30,000

Nikon CoolPix 3100

An outdoor's camera

If you are looking for a camera that takes great pictures, then meet the Nikon CoolPix 3100. This 3.2 mega pixel camera delivers 2048 x 1536 resolution images, which is enough for printing even on A4 size media. The 3x optical and the 4x digital zoom capture the finest details of the subject. The CoolPix 3100 is light and shaped such that it fits in your palm perfectly, and at the same time, offers an enhanced grip—even when you hold the camera with one hand. The macro focus range is as low as 4 cms. The camera is very compact, and weighs a little over 200 gms. Depending on the number of elements in the picture, you can store a minimum of 16 images and a maximum of 25 on the 16 MB Compact Flash memory—you can go up to 90 images, if taken at a resolution of 1024 x 768. The camera brings two AA Ni-MH rechargeable batteries, and a charger. The only problem is that it drains the normal alkaline batteries in no time.

The CoolPix delivered image quality equalled only by the Kodak DX 6340. The test image was completely focused and the alphabets on the CD and the keyboard text were readable. The specular effect was also impressive, with very lively reflections and a smooth effect on metal. It also reproduced the wrinkles on the cloth, something most cameras could not do. However, it disappointed us in the actual person test. The white wall appeared grainy, and the skin tones were darker than the actual colour. It yielded average results in the zoom test too. The camera is good for outdoor photography, and delivers excellent results with a little tweaking, such as manually setting the exposure setting, or using slower shutter speeds to get brighter images.

It's priced at Rs 25,500, which is a little on the higher side, taking into consideration that the camera consumes a lot of power when used with normal alkaline batteries.



"Fits exactly in the palm and has a wonderful colour correction, even if kept on the auto white balance mode. A smart digicam, which is worth buying if priced about Rs 2000 less."

—Sherwin Crasto

Nikon CoolPix 3100

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Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

+ Great ergonomics, chic looks
– Super hungry for alkaline batteries
Price: Rs 25,500

